



VELORA 1.0: Official Rulebook & Guidelines

1. Overview

VELORA 1.0 is a 24-hour national-level hackathon designed to foster innovation and practical technical skills. Participants will work in teams to design and develop functional prototypes for real-world problem statements within a constrained timeframe.

2. Eligibility & Team Formation

- **Eligibility:** The event is open to undergraduate students from all departments of MITAOE and other recognized colleges/institutes.
- **Team Size:** Each team must consist of **2 to 5 members**.
- **Diversity:** Inter-departmental and inter-college teams are permitted and encouraged to foster diverse collaboration.
- **Registration Integrity:** **Dummy registrations** will result in immediate disqualification.
- The registration deadline is **11:59 PM IST, 30 March 2026**, and **will not be increased** under any circumstances.

3. Event Structure

3.1 Round 1: Idea / PPT Submission

- **Process:** Teams must submit their information, problem domain preference, and a detailed presentation (PPT) describing their proposed solution, technical approach, and expected impact.
- **Evaluation Parameters:**
 - Clarity of problem understanding.
 - Innovation and feasibility of the proposed solution.
 - Technical approach.
 - Quality of the presentation.

3.2 Round 2: Final 24-Hour Hackathon (Offline)

- **Location:** MIT Academy of Engineering, Alandi.
- **Format:** A continuous 24-hour development sprint where teams build a working prototype. There should also be a video explanation which will explain the working of the prototype (5–6 min).
- **Support:** Teams will receive mentoring and undergo intermediate reviews throughout the 24 hours.

4. Technical Rules & AI Policy

- **AI Tool Usage:** Participants are **permitted to use LLMs and AI tools** (e.g., ChatGPT, Claude, GitHub Copilot).
- **Accountability:** If AI tools are used, the team **must be able to explain** every part of their work, including the logic and code generated. Failure to explain the technical implementation during reviews may lead to point deductions or disqualification.
- **Originality:** While tools are allowed, the core implementation and integration must reflect the team's own effort and understanding. If there is already an existing solution to the chosen problem, bring in your own innovation and uniqueness to it and mention it in the PPT, failure to do so may point deductions.

5. Evaluation & Judging Criteria

The final prototypes will be evaluated by a panel of industry experts and faculty members based on the following:

- **Completion Level:** How functional is the prototype within the 24-hour limit?
- **Technical Complexity:** The depth of coding, system design, and engineering involved.
- **Innovation:** The uniqueness of the solution and its potential real-world impact.
- **Presentation & Demo:** The ability to clearly demonstrate the project's features and answer technical questions.
- **Judges' Decision:** The decision of the judging panel is **final and binding** for all participants.

6. Logistics & On-Campus Conduct

- **Mandatory ID:** All participants must carry and display their **valid college ID cards** at all times.
- **Venue Rules:** Participants must remain within designated areas (Design Building and E Building) and are not allowed to loiter in restricted campus zones.
- **Overnight Stay:** The event is a 24-hour continuous sprint. Faculty and security will be present to ensure discipline.

- **Undertaking:** All offline participants will be needed to sign an undertaking about adherence to rules and disclosures. The format will be shared with shortlisted participants in due time.
- **Resources:** High-speed Wi-Fi, power points, and basic facilities like drinking water and washrooms will be provided.
- **Discipline:** Any form of misconduct, plagiarism, or violation of institute norms will lead to immediate disqualification and removal from the campus.

7. Important Dates

- **Registration Deadline:** 31 March 2026, 12:00 AM IST
- **Round 1 Results:** 05 April 2026, 12:00 PM
- **Final Offline Hackathon Start:** 11 April 2026, 12:00 PM